

REFRESH

TRAINING MANUAL

A Discipleship Journey Through the Biblical Story

8 SESSIONS

PARTICIPATORY | STORY-DRIVEN | REPRODUCIBLE

SESSION 1

Bigger Picture

The Beginning of the Biblical Story

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	The Beginning of the Biblical Story
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To introduce participants to the beginning of the biblical story, revealing who God is, why He created humanity, and how relationship, authority, and free will were established from the start. Lays the foundation for the rest of the story.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand who God is — one eternal, holy, faithful God who exists outside of time
- Recognize humanity's original purpose: vessels created to carry God's presence
- Understand free will and its connection to love
- Understand authority, ownership, and the origin of rebellion
- Recognize that spiritual death means separation from God

DO (Hands)

- Discuss God's attributes using personal language
- Engage with analogies about free will and stewardship
- Participate in the owner/manager roleplay

BECOME (Heart)

- Realize that human worth comes from being created by God
- Begin to see themselves as stewards, not owners
- Develop an awareness of the kingdom of darkness and its origin

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants begin to see themselves as vessels created by God, with value rooted in their Creator — not their achievements. They start to grasp the weight of free will, authority, and what was lost through rebellion.

Learning Philosophy

- NOT lecture-based
- HIGHLY participatory
- STORY-driven
- EXPERIENTIAL
- Pattern: Experience → Reflect → Truth → Apply → Demonstrate

Oral Learning Principles

- Use stories
- Use repetition
- Use group discussion
- Use physical movement
- Use simple language
- Break into small chunks

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection (Relational Entry)

- Ask: 'In India, how many gods do people worship?' — use to contrast multiple gods vs. the one true God
- Build trust through discussion and invitation

2

Engage — Experience First

- Activity: Open discussion on God's nature — invite participants to speak about God
- Explore attributes: goodness, faithfulness, holiness, eternity, transcendence
- Ask: 'What do you mean when you say He is good?' / 'What does faithfulness look like in action?'
- DO NOT explain yet — let them explore

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What did you see?
- What happened?
- How did it feel?
- Let participants interpret first — pay attention to what they say

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Key Truth: God exists outside of time; He created humanity as vessels to carry His presence
- Bridge: God (triune) outside of time created heavens, earth, and humanity inside time
- Scripture: Ephesians 1:4, Genesis 2:7, John 2:19-21, 1 Corinthians 3:16, 6:19-20
- Keep SHORT — oral culture retains short, repeated truth

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Hold up a 500ml bottle of Coke
- Ask: 'How much is this worth? Why?'
- Guide discussion: content inside, cost of production, what people will pay
- Bridge: 'How much was God willing to pay for you?' — connect to the cross

6**Practice — Participatory**

- Owner vs Manager roleplay: Assign owners, managers, and waiters/employees
- Let them act out: manager gives away resources without consulting the owner
- Discuss: Did the owner give away what belonged to them? What responsibility does the manager have?

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups present their roleplay
- Others give feedback
- Builds confidence and ownership

8**Teaching Point**

- Why the activity worked: ownership belongs to the creator
- God owns everything — humanity was given authority, not ownership
- We are stewards/managers, not owners
- Use New Guinea paddle story to anchor: you cannot use what doesn't belong to you
- Explain Authority & Satan's Rule: when a manager gives authority to another master, authority transfers

9**Application — Personal & Contextual**

- How will you use this?
- Ask: 'Am I managing as a steward or acting like I own what God gave me?'
- Discuss Introducing the Trees: Genesis 2–3 — Tree of Life vs Tree of Knowledge
- Free will is uniquely human — it's the ability to love God or reject Him

10**Activation / Response**

- Discussion: 'When Adam and Eve disobeyed, did God get angry or disappointed?'
- Branch illustration: Hold up a branch — 'What is wrong with this branch?'
- Core teaching: The branch is dead because it is separated from the tree
- Death = separation from God. God did not lie — death occurred the moment separation occurred
- Scripture: John 15

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat key idea together: 'Life comes from connection to the source'
- Use rhythm and repetition to anchor the truth

ACTIVITY DESIGN**Activity: Vessels — 500ml Coke Bottle**

Goal: Help participants understand that human value comes from who created them and what they contain, not from achievements or condition.

Type: Object lesson
Materials: 500ml bottle of Coke
Instructions:
1. Hold up the bottle and ask: 'How much is this worth? Why?'
2. Guide discussion: content inside, cost, what people pay
3. Introduce a scratched or dented bottle — 'Does damage remove value?'
Facilitator Notes: Address shame gently. Emphasize identity not performance. Connect to the cross — God put value on us through what He was willing to pay. Do NOT explain the full gospel yet.
Teaching Point: Humans are vessels. Value comes from the Creator, not condition.

Activity: Owner vs Manager Roleplay
Goal: Understand that humanity manages under God's authority — not as owners.
Type: Roleplay / skit
Instructions:
1. Assign roles: owner, manager, employees
2. Manager acts as if they own the restaurant — gives away resources without consulting the owner
3. Debrief: Did the owner ever give away what belonged to them? What is the manager's responsibility?
Teaching Point: Whoever we submit our hearts to ultimately influences the world through us. Authority is delegated, not possessed independently.

Activity: Branch Illustration
Goal: Participants understand that life comes from connection to the source.
Type: Object lesson
Materials: A branch (broken off a tree)
Instructions:
1. Hold up the branch and ask: 'Is this branch alive or dead? What is the problem?'

2. 'You could place it in sunlight, but it would still die.' — Why?

3. Explain: The branch is dead because it is separated from the tree.

Teaching Point: Separation is not a different type of death — separation IS death. Life = connection to God. Death = separation from God. God did not lie. (John 15)

SESSION 2

Two Kingdoms

The Reality of Darkness and the Hope of the Cross

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	The Reality of Darkness and the Hope of the Cross
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To reveal the reality of Satan as the deceiver, the king of lies, and the consequences of misaligned choices. To show the hope of the Cross — through Jesus, there is a new path, restoration, and connection to the Tree of Life. To call participants toward internal transformation, not just external behaviour change.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Identify Satan as the deceiver and understand eternal separation
- Understand judgment and the significance of how one exits life
- Grasp how the Cross creates a new road back to life

DO (Hands)

- Participate in the Cross Activity (experiential crossing)
- Reflect on the pig and cat illustration
- Identify personal areas of self-rule

BECOME (Heart)

- Recognize that self-effort and religion do not save
- Begin to understand that transformation must come from the inside out
- Desire to surrender self-rule and cross through Christ

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from seeing the Cross as a symbol to experiencing it as the only path from the kingdom of darkness to the kingdom of light. They begin to understand that God is after nature change — not behaviour modification.

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 1 briefly: 'Where did we end last time?'
- Ask: 'What stayed with you from the branch illustration?'
- Reconnect to the idea that separation = death

2

Engage — Experience First

- Cross Activity Setup (see Activity Design below)
- Say only: 'Everyone starts on this side. This is the kingdom of darkness. Your task: show me how you would move to the kingdom of light.'
- Before beginning: 'Go to the mud bowl and put mud on your hands or arms to represent the reality of sin.'
- DO NOT explain the symbolism — let participants act and observe

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- How are you feeling right now?
- What felt unfair?
- What confused you?
- What did you assume would work?

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Read Matthew 7:21-23 aloud after the activity
- Key Truth: Right language does not equal relationship. Spiritual activity does not equal knowing God. Works do not equal salvation.
- Explain the symbols: crowns = self-rule, water before the cross = religion, cross bridge = the only path, red cloth = righteousness given not earned

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Tell the pig and cat story: A wealthy woman loves her pig, dresses it beautifully. She leaves the door open. The pig runs outside and jumps in the mud.
- The pig will always return to the mud — because its nature has not changed.
- Connect: Sin is not the root problem — it is the result of a broken nature

6

Practice — Participatory

- Small groups: 'What external changes have you tried that didn't lead to real transformation?'
- Discuss: wise builder vs foolish builder (Matthew 7:24-27)
- 'What would your life be built on if examined today?'

7

Share & Multiply

- Groups share reflections
- Reinforce: the Cross is where nature exchange becomes possible
- Hope: 'God does not simply clean us from the outside; He transforms us from the inside'

8**Teaching Point**

- Before the Cross: separation, no access, broken relationship
- After the Cross: access restored, relationship opened, invitation given
- The Cross was never the final destination — it was the way BACK into relationship
- Introduce Kinosko (knowing God): not knowing about God, not Scripture knowledge — but deep, personal, covenantal knowing

9**Application**

- Ask: 'If your life was examined today, what would it be built on?'
- Ask: 'Are you wearing the plastic crown of self-rule?'
- 'Is there only one King in the Kingdom?'

10**Activation / Response**

- Prayer of surrender
- Speak it out loud: 'I give up the crown. I cross through Christ.'
- Commissioning if appropriate

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'The Cross is the only path. Righteousness is received, not earned.'
- Use rhythm and repetition

ACTIVITY DESIGN**Activity: The Cross Activity (Experiential Crossing)**

Goal: Help participants discover experientially that self-effort, religion, and status cannot save — only crossing through Christ can.

Type: Experiential / physical activity

Materials: Mud bowl, rope cross, plastic party crowns, bowl of water & towel, red cloths (hidden with assistants)

Physical Layout:

- Mark two areas: Kingdom of Darkness (start) and Kingdom of Light (far side)
- Lay rope in shape of a cross across the gap as the only crossing path
- Mud bowl + plastic crowns on darkness side; water & towel just before the cross; Kingdom of Light side: clean and empty

Instructions:

1. Tell participants to put mud on their hands (representing sin)
2. Say: 'Show me how you would move from the kingdom of darkness to the kingdom of light.' — Give no further hints.
3. Observe: who takes crowns, who washes first, who avoids the cross, who hesitates
4. Assistants quietly place red cloth on those who cross using the cross, whisper: 'Justified. Righteous.'
5. Move people back if they took a crown / avoided the cross / washed first / tried another route
Facilitator Notes: Let participants respond before teaching. Do debrief in 3 steps: (1) Emotional check-in, (2) Scripture anchor from Matthew 7:21-23, (3) Symbol explanation.
Teaching Point: Self-effort doesn't save. Religion doesn't save. Status and calling don't save. Only crossing through Christ saves. Righteousness is received, not earned.

Activity: Pig and Cat Story
Goal: Illustrate that the core problem of humanity is not behaviour but nature.
Type: Story
Story: A wealthy woman owns a pig she loves very much. She dresses it in nice clothes and puts perfume on it. One day she leaves the door open. The pig runs outside and immediately jumps into the mud. Even if she washes it, dresses it again, it will always go back to the mud — because its nature has not changed.
Key Verses: Ephesians 2:3, 4:22; Romans 6:6; Colossians 3:5, 3:9
Facilitator Notes: Keep focus on nature, not behaviour. Avoid making participants feel condemned. Connect to the gospel: Jesus came to give a new heart, not just clean people up.
Teaching Point: External changes cannot transform a person's heart. True transformation requires a new nature — which God provides through the cross.

SESSION 3

Covenant

Entering the New Covenant with God

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	Entering the New Covenant with God
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To equip participants to understand and enter the New Covenant with God personally. To show that salvation is by grace, not works, and involves repentance, belief, and submission. To guide participants toward a transformed, covenantal life that reflects Christ in thought, word, and action.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Explain the New Covenant and how it differs from the Old
- Understand the 5 elements of a covenant
- Know the difference between casual knowledge of Jesus and covenantal relationship

DO (Hands)

- Repent: turn from old works and patterns
- Believe: confess Jesus as Lord, trust in His death and resurrection
- Submit: commit to living under God's authority

BECOME (Heart)

- Move from external law to internal transformation
- Understand ongoing transformation as covenant life
- Make a personal decision to follow Christ and continue growing

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from 'knowing about Jesus' to entering a covenantal relationship with Him — understanding that the New Covenant is not a ritual but a personal act of repentance, belief, and submission.

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 2: 'The Cross is the only path. Righteousness is received, not earned.'
- Ask: 'What is the difference between knowing about someone and truly knowing them?'
- Use everyday examples: primary school friendships, high school, marriage

2

Engage — Experience First

- Invite participants to share: 'What does it mean to be truly known?'
- Use the whiteboard or visual: draw out the shift from Old to New Covenant
- Let participants explore first before teaching the framework

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What is the difference between a contract and a covenant?
- Why do you think good deeds alone can't save us? (Isaiah 64:6, Philippians 3:8)
- Let them wrestle with it before you teach

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Core Idea: God does not relate casually — He relates through covenant
- Define Covenant: A relationship made formal and binding by an act — not just words or feelings
- 5 Elements: (1) Defined relationship, (2) Formal establishing act (blood/sacrifice), (3) Responsibilities, (4) Promises/Outcomes (blessings & curses), (5) Sign/Seal
- OLD Covenant: 10 commandments, conditional, outside-in. Limitation: James 2:10 — stumble at one point, guilty of all
- NEW Covenant: Jeremiah 31:31-34, Ezekiel 36 — God forgives sins, writes law on hearts. Luke 22:20 — ratified by the blood of Jesus
- Sign Contrast: Old = external (circumcision, Sabbath). New = internal (Holy Spirit, Ephesians 1:13-14)

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Old Covenant: Read 'Personalized Commandments' aloud together
- Ask: 'Who wants the blessings?' (everyone nods) / 'Who will sign this contract knowing one mistake brings the curse?'
- New Covenant: Highlight the shift from 'You Must' (Old) to 'I Will' (New) — God takes responsibility

6

Practice — Participatory

- Trust Fall Activity: One participant climbs a ladder holding a crown (self-rule)
- Step 1 — Surrender: Give the crown away before falling
- Step 2 — Trust: Fall backward and be caught
- Step 3 — Exchange: As they are lowered, place a sash on them (new identity), mark forehead with an X (belonging)
- Key emphasis: Belief is not just mental agreement — it requires surrender + trust + receiving something new

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups discuss: 'Have you entered a covenant personally, or are you just acquainted with Jesus?'
- Reinforce: covenant is not about behaviour — it's about committed, exclusive love and obedience

8**Teaching Point**

- STEP 1 — REPENT (Metanoia): A moment of clarity. Prodigal Son (Luke 15:17). Turning from dead works — not shame, but acknowledgment
- STEP 2 — BELIEVE: Historical faith (1 Corinthians 15:3-6) + personal choice. Romans 10:9-11 — confess Jesus as Lord
- STEP 3 — SUBMIT: Giving up your rights. Surrendering your will. 'I regard my opinion as inferior to God's truth.' You now live doing the things of the King, not your own
- Connect submission to sonship: You are not just a servant — you are a son/daughter in the Father's house

9**Application**

- 'Who has the final say in your life right now?'
- 'Do I approach God to get something, or to belong and serve?'
- Orphan vs Son mindset: orphan = 'What can I get?' / son = 'How can I serve and add?'
- Covenant is ongoing — you continue to choose it. Real covenant leads to a changed life

10**Activation / Response**

- One-on-One with the King: invite participants to personally acknowledge where they stand
- Elements: (1) Acknowledge & repent, (2) Choose Christ & confess, (3) Trust & submit
- Galatians 2:20, 2 Corinthians 5:15, Romans 14:7-9
- Prayer / commitment / commissioning

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'Repent. Believe. Submit. This is how you enter the covenant.'
- Old Covenant: outside-in. New Covenant: inside-out

ACTIVITY DESIGN**Activity: Old vs New Covenant Whiteboard Illustration**

Goal: Move participants from the burden of external law to the freedom of internal transformation through Christ.

Type: Visual teaching / whiteboard

Instructions:

1. Draw a contrast table: Old Covenant on the left, New Covenant on the right

2. Fill in blessings, curses, sign/seal, responsibilities for each
3. Show the shift: 'You Must' → 'I Will' (Jeremiah 31:31-34)
Teaching Point: Old = outside-in. New = inside-out. The Law shows the standard (perfection) but gives zero power to achieve it. The New Covenant gives a new heart AND the power to obey.
Activity: Trust Fall
Goal: Illustrate that belief is trust that leads to surrender and response.
Type: Physical / experiential
Materials: Ladder or elevated platform, crown (prop), black sashes (old nature), white sashes (new heart), marker (to mark forehead with X), people positioned to catch safely
Instructions:
1. Participant climbs the ladder holding a crown
2. Surrender: Give the crown away before falling
3. Trust: Fall backward, be caught
4. Exchange: Place sash on them, mark forehead with X
Teaching Point: Belief = trust that leads to surrender and response. You only had to trust. Someone else changed the sashes — this is what God does.

SESSION 4

What Happens at the Cross?

Forgiveness, Identity, and New Life

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	Forgiveness, Identity, and New Life
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To help participants visualize their life before Christ and experience the freedom and forgiveness brought by the Cross. To connect personal reflection with biblical truth, affirming their new identity in Christ. To lead participants to embrace a new life, free from past sin, guilt, or shame.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand the permanence of forgiveness — God does not remember past sins
- Know their new status: justified, sanctified, set free
- Understand 2 Corinthians 5:17 — old life gone, new creation in Christ

DO (Hands)

- Visualize and release the old life through the sand exercise
- Declare their new nature and status before God
- Share testimony as evidence of God's transforming power

BECOME (Heart)

- Experience hope and empowerment for a life lived in the Spirit
- Affirm their new identity in Christ using scripture
- Break shame by speaking what God has forgiven

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from shame and guilt about their past to a genuine experience of forgiveness and a new identity. They leave knowing: 'My past is erased. God never thinks of it again. I am forgiven, justified, and made new.'

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 3: 'Repent. Believe. Submit. This is how you enter the covenant.'
- Ask: 'What does it feel like when something you did wrong is truly forgiven?'

2

Engage — Experience First

- Sand Exercise: Give each participant access to a sand tray or open ground
- Instruction: 'Draw in the sand everything in your life you wish had never happened — the good, the bad, everything. Only you will know what you draw.'
- Guide them to close their eyes and picture the Cross at the top of their life's drawing
- DO NOT explain yet — let participants reflect in silence

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What came up for you?
- What was hardest to draw?
- While they reflect silently, ERASE the sand drawing
- Ask participants to scratch in the sand — notice what is gone

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Key Truth: 'Your past is erased. God never thinks of it again. You are forgiven, justified, and made new.'
- Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:17, Galatians 2:20, Romans 7:6, 1 Peter 2:24, Colossians 1:13 & 2:13-14, Romans 3:23-26, Titus 3:5
- Use a reflective tone — pause between each declaration so participants can internalize it

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Trainer leads declarations aloud:
 - Nature Exchanged: Old heart replaced by Christ's heart
 - Status Before God: Justified, sanctified, set free
 - Identity: Child of God, member of His Kingdom, part of the Bride of Christ
 - Empowerment: Filled with Christ's fullness and the Holy Spirit
 - Triumph Over Satan: Cross and resurrection defeated sin and death

6

Practice — Participatory

- Small groups: 'What sins are you most happy about that God is never going to think of again?'
- Encourage participants to share the specific sins — this breaks shame and is very powerful
- Pair sharing: speak out loud what has changed

7

Share & Multiply

- Groups share testimonies of what happened at the Cross for them
- Reinforce: this is their story — they can now tell it to others

8**Teaching Point**

- God's forgiveness is permanent — He does not revisit what He has erased
- Salvation by grace, not works (Titus 3:5)
- The cross was the way back into relationship — the starting point, not the ending point

9**Application**

- Do you believe your sins have been washed away?
- How will you live differently knowing you are justified, not condemned?
- Personal journaling or silent prayer for internalizing the new identity

10**Activation / Response**

- Prayer of gratitude
 - Speaking declarations out loud together •
- Commissioning into new identity

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'Old life gone. New creation in Christ. God never thinks of my past again.'
- Use rhythm and repetition

ACTIVITY DESIGN**Activity: Life Before the Cross — Sand Exercise**

Goal: Help participants visualize their life before Christ and experience the freedom of forgiveness and transformation at the Cross.

Type: Reflective / experiential

Materials: Sand trays or access to sand / soft ground

Instructions:

1. 'Draw in the sand: everything in your life you wish had never happened — only you will know what you draw.'
2. Guide them to close their eyes and picture the Cross at the top of their life's drawing
3. While they reflect, erase the sand drawing
4. Ask them to scratch the sand and notice what is gone

Facilitator Notes: Walk around gently. Keep tone sensitive — some past experiences may be painful. Use a reflective tone throughout. Encourage personal journaling or silent prayer.

Teaching Point: Your past is erased. God never thinks of it again. You are forgiven, justified, and made new.

SESSION 5

Water Baptism

Obedience, Identity, and a New Kingdom

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	Obedience, Identity, and a New Kingdom
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To help participants understand that baptism is a step of obedience and submission that follows salvation. To show that baptism is a public identification with Jesus and a spiritual declaration of leaving the old life behind. To call participants into active response — moving from belief into obedience.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand baptism as a physical expression of internal transformation
- Recognize baptism as a dominion shift — from kingdom of darkness to Kingdom of God
- Understand the Red Sea as a biblical picture of baptism

DO (Hands)

- Recognize baptism as a necessary step of obedience, not just an optional symbol
- Understand that delayed obedience can hinder growth and freedom
- Make a personal decision to be baptised or affirm their baptism

BECOME (Heart)

- Experience baptism as declaring: 'I belong to Jesus'
- See it as a clear break from the old life and identity
- Understand that spiritual opposition may come — and that baptism is a moment of victory

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from viewing baptism as a ritual to understanding it as a decisive, personal act of surrender — drawing a line in the sand and declaring: 'I no longer belong to that kingdom.'

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 4: 'Old life gone. New creation in Christ.'
- Ask: 'Now that you are in the Kingdom — what does living differently look like?'
- Transition: 'The first act of obedience in the new kingdom is baptism'

2

Engage — Experience First

- Kingdom sash activity: Two different colour sashes, two groups standing opposite each other
- Participants from one group move out individually and approach someone one-on-one
- Ask quietly: 'Do you want to follow Jesus?'
- If yes → receive new sash (change of kingdom). If no response → remain where they are

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What did it feel like to be asked that question?
- What does it mean to change kingdoms?
- What would be different after crossing?

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- What is Baptism?
- Opportunity to submit — an act of obedience under Jesus as Lord
- Identification — declaring: 'I belong to Him'
- Physical portrayal — showing outwardly what has already happened inwardly
- Dominion shift — moving from the old life into new authority under Christ
- Biblical Picture: Egypt = old life. Passover (blood on doorposts) = salvation. Red Sea = baptism. Promised Land = new life under God
- The Red Sea was the last place Pharaoh had access to them — when they crossed, his dominion was broken
- Scripture: Colossians 1:13

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Trainer shares their own baptism story
- Personal stories help participants connect emotionally and build faith

6**Practice — Participatory**

- Small groups: 'Have you been baptised? What did it mean to you?'
- If not yet: 'What has stopped you?'
- Tibet Story: There were ten missionaries working very strategically and quietly. Only two of them worked directly with new believers. They had a small group — about seven believers — and they got to the point of baptism but then sent them away to pray about it.
- The first time they came back after about a month, the numbers had dropped — I think to around five. The missionaries said, 'Go and pray again. This is very important.'
- The next time they came back, there were only three left. The missionaries again said, 'Go and pray.' But this time the believers responded, 'We have to be baptised. Please don't send us away again.'
- So they baptised them. There was like a spring or river, and they all went in together and baptised them there.
- That same day, two of the three disappeared. The third one — we know her story because she wasn't at work that day. They only came for her the next day. God actually did a few miracles to sustain her, but she was tortured. They tied her hands behind her back and hung her from them, tearing the muscles in her shoulders. There were eight or ten officials sitting in front of her, and the question they kept asking was: 'How did you know about baptism? Who told you?'
- This just illustrates how powerful and significant baptism is.
- What does this story reveal about the significance of baptism?

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups share what they discussed
- Africa village story: Missionary preached, people believed, no baptism → people fell away. Third time, they believed AND were baptised → churches multiplied and remained strong
- Reinforce: baptism is not optional — it is part of discipleship

8**Teaching Point**

- Baptism is a line drawn in the sand — a declaration that 'I no longer belong to that kingdom'
- It is not a ritual or tradition — it requires personal, conscious faith and surrender
- Spiritual opposition may come when people choose obedience — this is expected, not defeat
- Baptism is a moment of victory: 'Pharaoh's dominion is broken'

9**Application**

- 'If you have not been baptised, what is your next step?'
- 'If you have been baptised, how can you help disciple others toward this obedience?'

10**Activation / Response**

- Invitation: 'Who is ready to take the step of baptism?'
- Prayer for those who commit
- Commissioning of those who have been baptised — send them to disciple others toward this step

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'Baptism is obedience. I declare: I belong to Jesus. I no longer belong to that kingdom.'

ACTIVITY DESIGN

Activity: Kingdom Sash Exchange
Goal: Physically and experientially represent the change of kingdoms that happens at salvation and is declared in baptism.
Type: Physical / experiential
Materials: 2 colour sashes, cones marking Kingdom of Darkness and Kingdom of Light
Instructions:
1. Two groups stand opposite each other in marked areas
2. One by one, participants cross to the other side and ask: 'Do you want to follow Jesus?'
3. 'Yes' → new sash (new kingdom). No response → remains
Facilitator Notes: Keep it personal and quiet. Don't rush. Allow the weight of the question to land.
Teaching Point: Salvation is personal — no one can decide for you. And once you decide, everything changes: your kingdom, your identity, your allegiance.

SESSION 6

Baptism of the Holy Spirit

Empowerment, Receiving, and Continuous Filling

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	Empowerment, Receiving, and Continuous Filling
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

We cannot do what God asks in our own strength — the Holy Spirit empowers us. Receiving the Holy Spirit is not separate from the covenant journey — it is central to it. God is equipping participants now for what He is calling them into.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand that the Holy Spirit is God's provision for obedience and empowerment within the covenant
- Know that there can be a gap between believing and receiving (Acts 19:2)
- Understand the continuous filling of the Spirit — 'be filled' is an ongoing command

DO (Hands)

- Receive the Holy Spirit by faith, not feeling
- Participate in ministry time (laying on of hands)
- Ask and receive — Luke 11 applied in practice

BECOME (Heart)

- Remove fear around the Holy Spirit and laying on of hands
- Discern the Spirit by fruit, not just manifestation
- Live in ongoing relationship with the Holy Spirit — not a once-off event

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from viewing the Holy Spirit as a secondary or optional experience to embracing Him as central to covenant life — a gift from a good Father, received by faith, lived in daily relationship.

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 5: 'Baptism is obedience. I declare: I belong to Jesus.'
- Ask: 'How do we do what God asks of us? In our own strength?'
- Transition: 'God equips you for what He asks of you'

2

Engage — Experience First

- Cup Illustration: Pour water into a cup. Then pull the cup away mid-pour.
- Also demonstrate the cup being kept far away or moving during pouring.
- DO NOT explain yet — let participants observe and sit with it

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What does the cup represent?
- What does pulling away represent?
- What stops us from being positioned to receive?

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Key Truth: God is not withholding — the issue is often our position or response
- Ephesians 1:13-14 — Sealed with the Holy Spirit (connect to the X on the forehead from Session 3)
- Acts 19:2 — 'Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?' — there can be a gap between believing and receiving
- Acts 8:15-17 — Peter and John walked 3 days to lay hands on believers. Ask: 'How important was this to them?'
- Acts 4:29-31 — Believers were filled AGAIN. 'Be filled' = continuous command
- Galatians / John 14 — We receive by faith, not feeling. Some feel, some sense, some know — all are valid
- Acts 5:32 — Given to those who obey. Not earned — but received in alignment with God
- Luke 11:11-13 — A good Father will not give something harmful. He gives the Holy Spirit to those who ask

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Tell the Free State story: A man in a conservative church falls from his chair while the speaker teaches about Jesus. He lands face down and makes a sheep sound.
- Afterwards: he had seen Jesus as a Shepherd searching for someone. He made the only sound he could. Every time he cried out, Jesus came closer — until He found him.
- Key: Focus on encounter and fruit — not just manifestation

6

Practice — Participatory

- Small groups: 'What fears do you have around the Holy Spirit or laying on of hands?'
- Discuss: 'Be careful who lays hands on you' — is darkness stronger than light? Truth: Light overcomes darkness
- Discernment: 'You will know a tree by its fruit. Don't be too quick to judge.'

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups share their discussions
- Invite: 'Has anyone received the Holy Spirit in a way you want to share?'

8**Teaching Point**

- The Holy Spirit is a gift — given by a good Father, received by faith, lived in ongoing relationship
- The model is not what's powerful — the model is what's biblical
- Everything must remain Christ-centred and Scripture-rooted
- Declaration: 'This is the will of God to give His Spirit to me. When I ask, He will give it.'

9**Application**

- 'Have you received the Holy Spirit since you believed?'
- 'What would it look like for you to be fully open to receive?'
- Invite participants to ask, with open hands and open hearts

10**Activation / Response — Ministry Time**

- Invite people to ask for the Holy Spirit, grounded in Luke 11
- Receive by faith. Don't strive. Be open.
- Lay hands (if appropriate). Encourage simple prayer. Speak truth, not hype.
- Keep it simple and Jesus-centred

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'The Holy Spirit is a gift. I ask. I receive by faith. He fills me continuously.'

ACTIVITY DESIGN

Activity: The Cup Illustration
Goal: Illustrate that God is pouring out His Spirit — and the question is whether we are positioned to receive.
Type: Object lesson
Materials: Cup, water jug or bottle
Instructions:
1. Pour water into a cup — normal and full
2. Pull the cup away mid-pour
3. Demonstrate the cup being kept far away, or moving during pouring
Facilitator Notes: Move slowly and intentionally. Let the visual speak before explaining. Tie into receiving by faith and openness.
Teaching Point: God is not withholding — the issue is often our position or response. Are you positioned to receive?

SESSION 7

Lordship

New Life, New Kingdom, New Way of Walking

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	New Life, New Kingdom, New Way of Walking
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

Now that participants are in the Kingdom, what does it mean to actually live there? This session explores what Lordship looks like in daily life — areas surrendered and areas not yet surrendered — and how wilful sin and self-rule can keep us stuck even after salvation.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand that being in the Kingdom requires ongoing surrender, not just a one-time decision
- Recognize the difference between a chair (unsurrendered area), a stake in the ground (living in circles), and a pole (wilful sin)
- Understand sowing and reaping:
sow to flesh → reap from flesh; sow to spirit → reap from spirit

DO (Hands)

- Identify specific areas of their life where Jesus does not yet have lordship
- Participate in the chair/rope activity to visualize connected areas of life
- Repent of sin and surrender areas where 'other kings' still reign

BECOME (Heart)

- Embrace the posture: 'He's always on His mission and I get to follow Him'
- Move from asking 'What am I allowed to do?' to 'Will this build or break my relationship with Christ?'
- Be ruthless with sin — choose not to sow to the flesh

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants move from passive belief to active, daily surrender — understanding that every area of life must come under Jesus' Lordship, and that wilful sin hardens the heart over time. They leave with a posture of ongoing discipleship and willingness to let Jesus reveal and rule every area.

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap Session 6: 'The Holy Spirit fills me continuously — I keep asking, keep receiving.'
- Ask: 'Now that you are in the Kingdom and filled with the Holy Spirit — what do you do now?'
- Transition: 'This session is about how we WALK in the new kingdom'

2

Engage — Experience First

- Chair/Rope Activity Setup:
 - Cones placed in the room (Kingdom of Light and Kingdom of Darkness areas)
 - Chairs are all connected by blue rope
 - Blue rope symbolises how areas of our life are connected
 - Label different chairs: church, family, money, education, hidden sin, relationships, etc.
 - Get a volunteer — tie the rope to them — another volunteer plays Jesus
 - Set up the volunteer's 'best life' scenario
- DO NOT explain yet — let the activity reveal itself

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- Walk through the scenario: 'One day she went to a small town and met Jesus. Jesus sits down.'
- 'Everything is perfect, right? What is wrong?'
- 'Jesus is sitting — you are welcome Jesus, but don't move.'
- Point to chairs still in the dark: 'Are these chairs in darkness or in light?'
- 'Is there pressure on your life all of a sudden?'
- 'What's the issue? There's a king sitting on that area of her life.'
- 'Does it mean she didn't get saved?'

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Three conditions illustrated by the activity:
 - 1. THE CHAIR — Not wilful sin. Following Jesus as best you can. But there are areas you haven't surrendered yet. A voice says 'You will never be saved' — but it's just an area not yet surrendered to God.
 - 2. THE STAKE IN THE GROUND — Walking in circles. Like a tribe that circled a mountain for a long time. You know where Jesus is going but can't seem to get there.
 - 3. THE POLE — Wilful, hidden sin. You have learned to speak the language of a Christian, walk like one, but have hidden sin. You feel stuck.
- Key Truth: 'If you choose wilful sin — it's like taking a red hot iron and burning your new heart, making it hard and callous.'
- Key Truth: 'Sin cannot take you out of Jesus's hands — but it can make you so hard of heart that you choose to walk away.'

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Marriage analogy: 'How many times can you flirt with someone other than your partner?'
- 'Does the marriage contract say that? No. So can he do it? How do you know it's wrong?'
- 'God is a jealous God — He doesn't want to share us.'
- Ask instead: 'Will this build my relationship with Christ, or break it?'

6**Practice — Participatory**

- Small groups: 'What are the chairs in your life — areas where Jesus is welcome but must not move?'
- 'Is there a stake in the ground — something you keep circling?'
- 'Is there a pole — hidden sin that has you feeling stuck?'
- Allow space to be honest — create a safe, non-shaming environment

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups share what came up
- Reinforce: He knows your heart. He says 'No' not to punish but because He sees the full picture
- He pulls everything into the light — He becomes our light

8**Teaching Point**

- Sow to your flesh → reap from your flesh. Sow to your spirit → reap from the Spirit.
- 'Too many people meet God and then walk away because they didn't understand: there is a life of surrender awaiting.'
- He's always on His mission — we get to FOLLOW Him
- Hidden sins may need to be brought into the light and given to God — sometimes to a trusted person — not to destroy trust but to build it.

9**Application**

- Take time tonight:
- Get sin in the light and repent of it
- Identify areas where the pressure is on — deal with it, surrender it
- Make sure there are no other kings you know of
- 'Have you learned what pressure feels like? Have you learned how to repent and renounce?'

10**Activation / Response**

- Prayer of repentance and surrender
- Specific: name the area/chair/stake/pole
- Commit: 'I do not sow to my flesh'
- Commissioning: 'I get to follow Him on His mission'

11**Recap — Oral Retention**

- Repeat: 'Sow to the Spirit. Surrender every area. He is always on His mission — I get to follow Him.'

ACTIVITY DESIGN

Activity: Chair and Rope — Building Someone's Life

Goal: Visually and experientially show that areas of our life are interconnected — and that Jesus wants Lordship over all of them, not just some.

Type: Roleplay / experiential

Materials: Chairs, blue rope, cones (Kingdom of Light / Darkness), chair labels (church, family, money, education, hidden sin, relationships, etc.), volunteer participants

Instructions:

1. Set up chairs connected by blue rope, each labelled with a life area
2. One volunteer is tied to the rope (represents the person). One plays Jesus.
3. Build a 'best life' scenario — show which chairs are in the light and which in the dark
4. Jesus enters and sits down. Ask: What is wrong?
5. Reveal: chairs in the dark still have another king sitting on them

Facilitator Notes: Go slowly. Let participants identify the problem before you name it. Avoid making anyone feel condemned — this is about ongoing surrender, not accusation.

Teaching Point: There are many places we don't know of that we haven't surrendered yet. Lordship is not a moment — it's a journey of continual surrender.

SESSION 8

Final Day — Sent

The Bigger Story, Your Calling, and What Comes Next

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Training Title:	Refresh Discipleship Training
Theme:	The Bigger Story, Your Calling, and What Comes Next
Audience:	Oral learners / mixed literacy / cross-cultural discipleship context

PURPOSE — Why This Session Exists

To bring the full journey to completion — from creation to the cross to commissioning. To show that salvation is not the end of the story but the beginning of a life sent on mission. To call participants into their unique calling within the one great calling: make disciples of all nations.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

KNOW (Head)

- Understand the full arc: Creation → Fall → Cross → New Covenant → Calling
- Know the difference between Old Covenant (obey to live) and New Covenant (to live is to obey)
- Understand that 2.5 billion people have never heard — and God designed each person with a specific calling

DO (Hands)

- Review the core truths of the training and articulate them to someone else
- Identify their personal sphere and calling
- Create a plan to disciple others using what they have learned

BECOME (Heart)

- Embrace the posture: 'He chooses me and sends me'
- Understand that callings are different but position is the same
- Leave commissioned — not just informed

TRANSFORMATION GOAL

Participants leave not just with knowledge of the biblical story — but with a sense of their place IN that story. They understand that the love story of God is ongoing, that they have been chosen and sent, and that the nations are met in daily life.

SESSION FRAMEWORK

1

Welcome & Connection

- Recap the full journey: 'Where did we start? Where are we now?'
- Keep referring back to the branch: 'What was the problem? Separation. What is the solution? Connection.'
- Ask: 'What has changed in you over these sessions?'

2

Engage — Experience First

- Watch: Video on calling (Messenger Studios — video on calling)
- Let it land before discussion
- DO NOT explain yet — let them respond to it first

3

Reflect — Draw Out Discovery

- What stirred in you watching that?
- Did you see yourself in it?
- What does calling mean to you?

4

Reveal Truth — Short Teaching

- Full Story Recap: God is a love story — the key to eternity
- Jesus fulfilled the requirement of the covenant
- Old covenant: obey to live. New covenant: to live is to obey
- How do you accept the covenant? Repent. Believe. Submit. What do we repent of? Dead works.
- So why are we still here? Not all have heard. Some people walk in circles their whole life.
- God designed us with purpose — like Abraham: 'Through your generations, everyone will be blessed'
- After the cross: First church born — Book of Acts — 'Proclaiming the Kingdom of God is at hand'
- 2.5 billion people have never heard
- Everyone was made different — each individual has a different calling
- John Wesley's mother: she prayed under her apron — raising John in the fear of God. The fruit of his life. If she believed cultural norms she might have said: 'I don't want any children.'
- Callings are different but position is the same — we live in a world on its way to be without God for eternity
- 'When you exit, God is going to ask you: What did you do with your calling? Did you do what I asked?'

5

Demonstrate — Model It

- Nations are met in daily life — in spheres
- When we are discipling, we cannot pull people OUT of their calling because we think ours is more important
- Use participants' own stories to illustrate different callings in different spheres

6

Practice — Participatory

- Small groups: 'What is your sphere? Where are the nations for you?'
- 'What would it look like to multiply this training in your sphere?'
- Each group creates a simple plan: who will they disciple? Using what?

7**Share & Multiply**

- Groups share their plans
- Practice teaching: one person from each group summarizes a session truth for the others
- Peer feedback: What was clear? What could be clearer?
- Ask: 'Can they now teach this to someone else?' — this is the test of multiplication

8**Teaching Point**

- Is there an end to this amazing love story? Yes — Revelation 21
- The Cross was never the final destination — it was the way back into relationship
- God is speaking about something deeper than words — love story is the key to eternity
- 'He's always on His mission. I get to follow Him.'

9**Application**

- 'What is the one thing you are taking away from this training?'
- 'Who is one person you will disciple using what you've learned?'
- 'What is your next step?'

10**Activation / Response — Final Commissioning**

- Prayer over participants
- Commissioning: spoken aloud, called by name if possible
- 'You are now sent. You are not the end of the story — you are the next chapter.'
- Celebration of what God has done in the room

11**Recap — Full Training Summary**

- Creation: God created us as vessels. Value comes from the Creator.
- Fall: Separation is death. The branch cut off from the tree.
- Kingdoms: The Cross is the only path. Righteousness is received, not earned.
- Covenant: Repent. Believe. Submit. Inside-out transformation.
- Cross: Forgiven. Justified. New creation.
- Baptism: I declare I belong to Jesus. Dominion shift.
- Holy Spirit: I receive by faith. He fills me continuously.
- Lordship: Sow to the Spirit. Surrender every area. Follow Him.
- Sent: He is always on His mission. I get to follow Him.

ACTIVITY DESIGN**Activity: Practice Teaching — Multiplication Check**

Goal: Ensure that participants can now teach what they have learned to someone else — the true test of reproducibility.

Type: Practice teaching / peer feedback

Instructions:

1. Each group is assigned one session from the training
2. One person from the group teaches the key truth of that session in 3 minutes
3. The rest of the room gives feedback: What was clear? What would you add?

Facilitator Notes: Celebrate every attempt. Keep feedback encouraging and constructive. Simple and true is better than polished and complicated.

Teaching Point: If they can teach it, they own it. If they own it, it will multiply. The training is not complete until it is reproducible.

Final Activation: Real-Life Application Plan

Each participant answers:

- WHO will I disciple using what I have learned?
- WHEN and WHERE will I start?
- WHAT is one activity or truth I will use first?
- HOW will I keep accountability?